ideological fervour and competence that could rejuvenate the Congress as an effective instrument to safeguard the constitutional Idea of India.

Section two details the collective experiences of the Bharat yatris. Although they were conjoined in how they navigated the Yatra's logistics, each of them experienced it quite differently, based on their unique socio-economic, political and cultural worldviews. For some the Yatra was a historical duty; for others it was a chance to prove their ideological commitment to their leaders; for some others, it was a chance to do something purposeful. And despite their unique vantage points, they found commonalities that bound them together. For example, Chandy Oommen (from Kerala) walked almost the entire Yatra barefoot to connect in a deeper way with it, as well as with the most vulnerable. Similarly, Lhingkim Haokip (from Manipur), who completed the Yatra despite an ankle injury, found strength in the community she was walking with and in their joint discovery of the new. Mirroring that sentiment, Kanhaiya Kumar (from Bihar) found that the collective rigours of the Yatra revealed the inner being of each individual, which they otherwise shielded with armour they constructed for themselves. Likewise, R. Sudha (from Tamil Nadu) felt the Yatra broke these internal barriers and ceilings, and tethered them in new ways. Similarly, Dr Anshul Trivedi (from Madhya Pradesh) made special efforts to engage in a dialectic to connect with the moral, intellectual and ideological understanding of each yatri when faced with his own 'otherness' in the south. I think that dialectic and consequent fraternity is best encapsulated in Jothi Mani's (from Tamil Nadu) description of the collective trauma the Yatra suffered when a senior parliamentarian succumbed to a cardiac arrest while on the Yatra. Their frantic efforts to save him, their shared grief and the strength they gave each other attest to a special bond that transcends mere camaraderie.

At the most obvious level, section two gives the reader a rare insight into the thinking of diverse political entrepreneurs, as well as their individual journeys and worldviews. But what is especially striking is the organic transcension of psychological barriers and prejudices. It is very interesting to study how individual paths coalesce to the same realization, and how